1. Tod (1839): 370–1.

2. Later, the need to understand Ashokan epigraphs as integrated wholes was underlined by Upinder Singh, who spoke of them as epigraph-monuments: Singh 1997–8: 1–3.

3. Line 8 in Kielhorn (1905–6): 47.The epigraph provides an exceptionally vivid account of the lake and bund and its destruction in 150 CE in a storm: ‘the clouds pouring with rain the earth had been converted as it were into one ocean.’ Consequently, the swollen floodwaters simply ‘tore down hill-tops, trees, banks, turrets, upper stories, gates and raised places of shelter’ (lines 5–7). The dam, built during the time of Chandragupta, suffered a huge breach and the Sudarshana lake drained out. Rudradaman’s minister Suvishaka then carried out repairs, creating a dam three times larger than the original.

4. These details and those pertaining to what was added in the time of Ashoka are there in Line 8 of the epigraph.

5. Spodek (1974): 451 demonstrates this.

6. Rajyagor (1975–9): 8.

7. Tod (1839): 401.

8. Ghosh (1989): 350.

9. Spodek (1974): 450.

10. Marshall (1951): 95.

11. How this was identified is described in Jamsedjee (1890–4): 47–55.

12. Jamsedjee (1890–4): 54.

13. Lahiri (2011). A great deal mentioned here formed part of my field survey in 2011 in Junagadh and its surrounding area.

14. The bricks used for the stupa measure 45.7 x 38.1 x 7.62 cm.

15. Cousens (1891): 21.

16. Rawat (2009): 99–100.

17. Strong (1989): 219. In the words of the *Ashokavadana*: ‘Asoka had eighty-four thousand boxes made of gold, silver, cat’s eye, and crystal, and in them were placed the relics. Also, eighty-four thousand urns and eighty-four thousand inscription plates were prepared. All of this was given to the yaksas for distribution in the (eighty-four thousand) dharmarajikas he ordered built throughout the